Hence, the imperative of decoloniality to prevent the decimation of what remains of Bharat's indigeneity.

In a foray into the history of the seventeenth-century British incursion into Bharat, Sai Deepak highlights the cultural and religious nature of the East India Company's motivations, wrongly depicted in most historical accounts as essentially commercial. Propagating the gospel was affirmed as a purpose at the very outset in 1614 and subsequently repeated unequivocally, and the East India Company was specifically authorised to make war on 'heathen nations' by a Charter in 1683. One critical dimension of colonial experiences was the policy of tolerating the scriptural and doctrinal essence of Hinduism and delegitimising popular practices, adjudged by colonial bureaucrats to be superstitious. The intervention imposed a thoroughly distortive Christian paradigm of separation between the religious and the secular, meaningless in terms of Indic/Dharmic philosophical perceptions and practices. The most enduring aspect of colonial interference, prompted by cognisance of temple wealth, was in successive legislative acts introducing State regulation of temples. It is this legacy that haunts the integrity and very durability of Sanatana Dharma in independent Bharat and the insistence of governments of all political stripes to allow the progressive degradation of temples.

In two revelatory concluding chapters, Sai Deepak graphically revisits the debates and legislative acts that preceded Bharat's First War of Independence in 1857 and those that followed the assumption of direct rule over Bharat by the Westminster government and its designated representatives in Bharat. It is amply clear that effective political rule to pre-empt future revolts remained Christian in spirit, despite the Queen's proclamation of religious neutrality in 1858, with all the antecedent precepts of toleration continuing to be deeply imbued with Christian prejudices imposed on Hindu society and practice, viz official hostility towards alleged superstitions, etc. At the same time, the British debate on governing Bharat continued to reiterate the desirability of mass conversions of idolators, publicly and resoundingly articulated by the Archbishop of Canterbury and supported by the then British prime minister. In addition, successive Government of India Acts of the British Parliament modifying the Act of 1858 extended some legislative representation to Bharatiyas, but the underlying ethos of the primacy of European Christian theological inspiration motivating the coloniser remained intact.